

Time-lapse

Time-lapse is not photography *per se*, it moves into the realm of movie making. Time-lapse is a very powerful medium to document extremely slow moving natural phenomena, the most common being cloud movement, blooming flowers and rotting fruits.

The concept is to take a single image with a significant lapse in time, and then sequentially play the images at a standard rate of 24 frames per second (fps) in a video. This means that a large number of photographs have to be taken across a span of time. At a frame rate of 24 fps, you would need 1440 pictures to make a one minute video. However, for most practical purposes using a frame rate of 16 fps produces equally dramatic results.

Many cameras in the Canon Powershot series, a handful of Nikon and Pentax cameras, and two Nikon Coolpix models come with a time-lapse option. However, you can take Time-lapse using any camera, and don't need to use a preset function for this purpose. A usual prerequisite for taking a good time-lapse is a tripod. The next step is choosing a good subject.

You missed the best times for taking cloud time-lapse in India by a month. The month of October has a lot of different currents at different altitudes providing those evolving cloud time-lapses that you have seen. A sunset or a sunrise is always a good subject. Other probable subjects include any work of art in the making, such as paintings, graffiti or *rangoli*. Blooming or rotting flowers, rotting fruits, curdling milk are all good and well documented subjects. Also, consider crowds, traffic, and traffic in the night time. If you are willing to spend a little more time with your time-lapse, consider a building being constructed or a growing plant. Anything that moves slowly, or changes slowly over a vast period of time is a great subject for time-lapse.

Once the subject is chosen, the most difficult part of time-lapse comes into picture. This is deciding how many pictures to take and how often. If the chosen subject is the sunset or cloud motion, then a photo every fifteen seconds is ideal. Consider a photo every five seconds for fast moving subjects like traffic or crowds, the more you space it out, the less will